

**UNITED STATES
SECURITIES AND EXCHANGE COMMISSION
Washington, D.C. 20549**

FORM 8-K

CURRENT REPORT

Pursuant to Section 13 OR 15(d) of The Securities Exchange Act of 1934

Date of Report (Date of earliest event reported): **February 12, 2024**

ARISTA NETWORKS, INC.

(Exact name of registrant as specified in its charter)

Delaware

(State or other jurisdiction of
incorporation)

001-36468

(Commission File Number)

20-1751121

(IRS Employer Identification
No.)

**5453 Great America Parkway
Santa Clara, CA 95054**

(Address of principal executive offices) (Zip Code)

(408) 547-5500

(Registrant's telephone number, including area code)

Not Applicable

(Former name or former address, if changed since last report)

Check the appropriate box below if the Form 8-K filing is intended to simultaneously satisfy the filing obligation of the registrant under any of the following provisions (see General Instruction A.2. below):

- ☐ Written communications pursuant to Rule 425 under the Securities Act (17 CFR 230.425)
- ☐ Soliciting material pursuant to Rule 14a-12 under the Exchange Act (17 CFR 240.14a-12)
- ☐ Pre-commencement communications pursuant to Rule 14d-2(b) under the Exchange Act (17 CFR 240.14d-2(b))
- ☐ Pre-commencement communications pursuant to Rule 13e-4(c) under the Exchange Act (17 CFR 240.13e-4(c))

Securities registered pursuant to Section 12(b) of the Act:

Title of each class	Trading Symbol(s)	Name of each exchange on which registered
Common Stock, \$0.0001 par value	ANET	New York Stock Exchange

Indicate by check mark whether the registrant is an emerging growth company as defined in Rule 405 of the Securities Act of 1933 (§230.405 of this chapter) or Rule 12b-2 of the Securities Exchange Act of 1934 (§240.12b-2 of this chapter).

Emerging growth company ☐

If an emerging growth company, indicate by check mark if the registrant has elected not to use the extended transition period for complying with any new or revised financial accounting standards provided pursuant to Section 13(a) of the Exchange Act. ☐

ITEM 2.02 Results of Operations and Financial Condition.

On February 12, 2024, Arista Networks, Inc. (the “Company”) issued a press release announcing its financial results for the quarter and year ended December 31, 2023. The full text of the press release is attached hereto as Exhibit 99.1 and is incorporated herein by reference.

This information and Exhibit 99.1 are intended to be furnished under Item 2.02, “Results of Operations and Financial Condition,” and Item 9.01, “Financial Statements and Exhibits,” of Form 8-K and shall not be deemed “filed” for purposes of Section 18 of the Securities Exchange Act of 1934, as amended (the “Exchange Act”), or otherwise subject to the liabilities of that Section, nor shall it be deemed incorporated by reference in any filing under the Securities Act of 1933, as amended, or the Exchange Act, except as shall be expressly set forth by specific reference in such a filing.

ITEM 9.01 Financial Statements and Exhibits.

(d) Exhibits

<u>Exhibit No.</u>	<u>Description</u>
99.1	Press release issued by Arista Networks, Inc. dated February 12, 2024
104	Cover Page Interactive Data File (embedded within the Inline XBRL document)

SIGNATURES

Pursuant to the requirements of the Securities Exchange Act of 1934, the registrant has duly caused this report to be signed on its behalf by the undersigned hereunto duly authorized.

February 12, 2024

ARISTA NETWORKS, INC.

/s/ ITA BRENNAN

Ita Brennan

Chief Financial Officer

(Principal Accounting and Financial Officer)

Arista Networks, Inc. Reports Fourth Quarter and Year End 2023 Financial Results

SANTA CLARA, Calif.- February 12, 2024 -- Arista Networks, Inc. (NYSE: ANET), an industry leader in data-driven, client to cloud networking for large data center, campus and routing environments, today announced financial results for its fourth quarter and the full year ended December 31, 2023.

"I am truly honored to be a part of the leadership team that will drive Arista 2.0 products and technology for enterprise, cloud and AI customers," said incoming CFO Chantelle Breithaupt. "As we enter 2024, we remain focused on satisfying their most demanding requirements with our compelling, innovative networking solutions."

Full Year Financial Results

- Revenue of \$5,860.2 million, an increase of 33.8% compared to fiscal year 2022.
- GAAP gross margin of 61.9%, compared to GAAP gross margin of 61.1% in fiscal year 2022.
- Non-GAAP gross margin of 62.6%, compared to non-GAAP gross margin of 61.9% in fiscal year 2022.
- GAAP net income of \$2,087.3 million, or \$6.58 per diluted share, compared to GAAP net income of \$1,352.4 million, or \$4.27 per diluted share, in fiscal year 2022.
- Non-GAAP net income of \$2,199.4 million or \$6.94 per diluted share, compared to non-GAAP net income of \$1,448.3 million or \$4.58 per diluted share, in fiscal year 2022.

Fourth Quarter Financial Results

- Revenue of \$1,540.4 million, an increase of 2.1% compared to the third quarter of 2023, and an increase of 20.8% from the fourth quarter of 2022.
- GAAP gross margin of 64.9%, compared to GAAP gross margin of 62.4% in the third quarter of 2023 and 60.3% in the fourth quarter of 2022.
- Non-GAAP gross margin of 65.4%, compared to non-GAAP gross margin of 63.1% in the third quarter of 2023 and 61.0% in the fourth quarter of 2022.
- GAAP net income of \$613.6 million, or \$1.92 per diluted share, compared to GAAP net income of \$427.1 million, or \$1.35 per diluted share, in the fourth quarter of 2022.
- Non-GAAP net income of \$664.3 million, or \$2.08 per diluted share, compared to non-GAAP net income of \$445.1 million, or \$1.41 per diluted share, in the fourth quarter of 2022.

Commenting on the company's financial results, Ita Brennan, Arista's outgoing CFO said, "Our outstanding performance for 2023 epitomizes our focus on profitable revenue growth, expanding our enterprise and campus footprint while leveraging R&D and go-to-market investments across the business."

Fourth Quarter Company Highlights

- Arista 7130 Series Leads the Way to 25G Ultra-Low Latency Networking – announcing the next generation 7130 Series for ultra-low latency switching that accelerates 25G networking. With three new 25G optimized systems, enhanced performance optics, 25G ready FPGA applications and updates to the FDK (FPGA Development Kit), Arista is addressing the needs for 25G market data distribution and High-Frequency Trading (HFT) environments.
- Arista Networks Unveils Zero Trust Networking Vision – announcing an expanded zero trust networking architecture that uses the underlying network infrastructure to break down security silos, streamline workflows and enable an integrated zero trust program. Through a combination of Arista-developed

technologies and strategic alliances with key partners, this approach uses the network to compensate for harder-to-implement zero trust controls across the domains of devices, workloads, identity, and data.

- Arista Networks Appoints New CFO – announcing the appointment of Chantelle Breithaupt as the company's CFO, effective February 2024.

Full Year Company Highlights

- The Arrival of Open AI Networking – Arista and the founding members of the Ultra Ethernet Consortium (UEC) have set out on the mission to enhance the capabilities of Ethernet for AI and HPC.
- Arista Networks Introduces AI-Driven Network Identity – Arista introduced a cloud-delivered, AI-driven network identity service for enterprise security and IT operations.
- In the first half of 2023, Arista surpassed 75 million cloud network ports shipped cumulatively.
- Arista Named a Leader in The Forrester Wave™: Network Analysis and Visibility, Q2 2023 which notes that “Arista Networks’ deployment flexibility is second to none.”
- Arista Modernizes Routing in the Wide Area Network - Arista introduced the Arista WAN Routing System, which combines three new networking offerings: enterprise-class routing platforms, carrier/cloud-neutral internet transit capabilities, and the CloudVision® Pathfinder Service to simplify and improve customer wide area networks.
- Arista Showcases Next Generation Systems and Optics for Cloud, Internet Service Provider, and Enterprise Networks - Arista announced its range of products and solutions, along with perspectives on the petascale era of cloud networking and the systems and optics required to meet the demands of new AI/ML-driven network architectures.

Financial Outlook

For the first quarter of 2024, we expect:

- Revenue between \$1.52 billion to \$1.56 billion;
- Non-GAAP gross margin of approximately 62%; and
- Non-GAAP operating margin of approximately 42%.

Guidance for non-GAAP financial measures excludes stock-based compensation expense, amortization of acquisition-related intangible assets, and other acquisition-related costs. A reconciliation of non-GAAP guidance measures to corresponding GAAP measures is not available on a forward-looking basis because these exclusions can be uncertain or difficult to predict, including stock-based compensation expense which is impacted by the company's future hiring and retention needs and the future fair market value of the company's common stock. The actual amount of these exclusions will have a significant impact on the company's GAAP gross margin and GAAP operating margin.

Prepared Materials and Conference Call Information

Arista's executives will discuss the fourth quarter and year end 2023 financial results on a conference call at 1:30 p.m. Pacific time today. To listen to the call via telephone, dial (888) 330-2502 in the United States or +1 (240) 789-2713 from international locations. The Conference ID is 5655862.

The financial results conference call will also be available via live webcast on Arista's investor relations website at <https://investors.arista.com/>. Shortly after the conclusion of the conference call, a replay of the audio webcast will be available on Arista's investor relations website.

Forward-Looking Statements

This press release contains “forward-looking statements” regarding our future performance, including quotations from management, statements in the section entitled “Financial Outlook,” such as estimates regarding revenue,

non-GAAP gross margin and non-GAAP operating margin for the first quarter of 2024 and statements regarding the benefits of Arista's products. Forward-looking statements are subject to known and unknown risks, uncertainties, assumptions and other factors that could cause actual results, performance or achievements to differ materially from those anticipated in or implied by the forward-looking statements including risks associated with: large purchases by a limited number of customers who represent a substantial portion of our revenue; adverse economic and geopolitical conditions and conflicts, including inflationary pressures which result in increased component costs and reduced information technology and network infrastructure spending, the Russia/Ukraine, Israel/Hamas conflicts and the Houthi attacks on marine vessels in the Red Sea; changes in our customers technology roadmaps and priorities including the need for the rapid deployment of artificial intelligence ("AI") and related technologies; the impact of sole or limited sources of supply, supply shortages and extended lead times or supply changes; volatility in our revenue growth rate; variations in our results of operations; the rapid evolution of the networking market; failure to successfully carry out new products and service offerings and expand into adjacent markets; variability in our gross margins; intense competition and industry consolidation; expansion of our international sales and operations; investments in or acquisitions of other businesses; seasonality and industry cyclicality; fluctuations in currency exchange rates; failure to raise additional capital on favorable terms; our inability to attract new large customers or sell additional products and services to our existing customers; sales of our switches generating most of our product revenue; large customers requiring more favorable terms; inability to increase market awareness or acceptance of our new products and services; decreases in the sales prices of our products and services; long and unpredictable sales cycles; declines in maintenance renewals by customers; product quality problems; failure to anticipate technological shifts; managing the supply of our products and product components; our dependence on third-party manufacturers to build our products; assertions by third parties of intellectual property rights infringement; failure to protect or assert our intellectual property rights; defects, errors or vulnerabilities in our products, the failure of our products to detect security breaches or incidents, the misuse of our products or the risks or product liability; enhanced U.S. tax, tariff, import/export restrictions, Chinese regulations or other trade barriers; failure to comply with government law and regulations; issues in the development and use of artificial intelligence, combined with an uncertain regulatory environment; and other future events. Additional risks and uncertainties that could affect us can be found in our most recent filings with the Securities and Exchange Commission including, but not limited to, our annual report on Form 10-K and quarterly reports on Form 10-Q. You can locate these reports through our website at <https://investors.arista.com/> and on the SEC's website at <https://www.sec.gov/>. All forward-looking statements in this press release are based on information available to the company as of the date hereof and we disclaim any obligation to publicly update or revise any forward-looking statement to reflect events that occur or circumstances that exist after the date on which they were made.

Non-GAAP Financial Measures

This press release and accompanying table contain certain non-GAAP financial measures including non-GAAP gross profit, non-GAAP gross margin, non-GAAP income from operations, non-GAAP operating margin, non-GAAP net income and non-GAAP diluted net income per share. These non-GAAP financial measures exclude stock-based compensation expense, amortization of acquisition-related intangibles and other acquisition-related expenses, gains/losses on strategic investments, an intellectual property dispute settlement, and the income tax effect of these non-GAAP exclusions. In addition, non-GAAP financial measures exclude net tax benefits associated with stock-based awards, which include excess tax benefits, and other discrete indirect effects of such awards. The company uses these non-GAAP financial measures internally in analyzing its financial results and believes that these non-GAAP financial measures are useful to investors as an additional tool to evaluate ongoing operating results and trends. In addition, these measures are the primary indicators management uses as a basis for its planning and forecasting for future periods.

Non-GAAP financial measures are not meant to be considered in isolation or as a substitute for the comparable GAAP financial measures. Non-GAAP financial measures are subject to limitations, and should be read only in

conjunction with the company's consolidated financial statements prepared in accordance with GAAP. Non-GAAP financial measures do not have any standardized meaning and are therefore unlikely to be comparable to similarly titled measures presented by other companies. A description of these non-GAAP financial measures and a reconciliation of the company's non-GAAP financial measures to their most directly comparable GAAP measures have been provided in the financial statement tables included in this press release, and investors are encouraged to review the reconciliation.

About Arista Networks

Arista Networks is an industry leader in data-driven, client to cloud networking for large data center, campus and routing environments. Arista's award-winning platforms deliver availability, agility, automation, analytics and security through an advanced network operating stack. For more information, visit <https://www.arista.com>.

ARISTA, EOS, CloudVision, NetDL and AVA are among the registered and unregistered trademarks of Arista Networks, Inc. in jurisdictions around the world. Other company names or product names may be trademarks of their respective owners. Additional information and resources can be found at www.arista.com.

ARISTA NETWORKS, INC.
Condensed Consolidated Statements of Operations
(Unaudited, in thousands, except per share amounts)

	Three Months Ended December 31,		Twelve Months Ended December 31,	
	2023	2022	2023	2022
Revenue:				
Product	\$ 1,310,314	\$ 1,096,866	\$ 5,029,493	\$ 3,716,079
Service	230,123	178,686	830,675	665,231
Total revenue	1,540,437	1,275,552	5,860,168	4,381,310
Cost of revenue:				
Product	495,826	471,617	2,061,167	1,573,629
Service	45,385	35,329	168,720	131,985
Total cost of revenue	541,211	506,946	2,229,887	1,705,614
Total gross profit	999,226	768,606	3,630,281	2,675,696
Operating expenses:				
Research and development	211,481	190,423	854,918	728,394
Sales and marketing	105,538	85,443	399,034	326,955
General and administrative	42,293	23,821	119,080	93,241
Total operating expenses	359,312	299,687	1,373,032	1,148,590
Income from operations	639,914	468,919	2,257,249	1,527,106
Other income, net	54,477	16,926	164,777	54,690
Income before income taxes	694,391	485,845	2,422,026	1,581,796
Provision for income taxes	80,755	58,756	334,705	229,350
Net income	\$ 613,636	\$ 427,089	\$ 2,087,321	\$ 1,352,446
Earnings per share:				
Basic	\$ 1.97	\$ 1.39	\$ 6.75	\$ 4.41
Diluted	\$ 1.92	\$ 1.35	\$ 6.58	\$ 4.27
Weighted-average common shares outstanding:				
Basic	311,612	306,162	309,354	306,473
Diluted	318,845	315,201	317,135	316,459

ARISTA NETWORKS, INC.
Reconciliation of Selected GAAP to Non-GAAP Financial Measures
(Unaudited, in thousands, except percentages and per share amounts)

	Three Months Ended December 31,		Twelve Months Ended December 31,	
	2023	2022	2023	2022
GAAP gross profit	\$ 999,226	\$ 768,606	\$ 3,630,281	\$ 2,675,696
GAAP gross margin	64.9 %	60.3 %	61.9 %	61.1 %
Stock-based compensation expense	3,273	3,075	12,789	9,688
Intangible asset amortization	4,195	6,821	23,457	25,374
Non-GAAP gross profit	<u>\$ 1,006,694</u>	<u>\$ 778,502</u>	<u>\$ 3,666,527</u>	<u>\$ 2,710,758</u>
Non-GAAP gross margin	65.4 %	61.0 %	62.6 %	61.9 %
GAAP income from operations	\$ 639,914	\$ 468,919	\$ 2,257,249	\$ 1,527,106
Stock-based compensation expense	81,358	64,954	296,756	230,934
Intangible asset amortization	6,690	9,316	33,437	33,650
Acquisition-related costs ⁽¹⁾	—	—	—	4,691
Legal settlement ⁽²⁾	16,000	—	16,000	—
Non-GAAP income from operations	<u>\$ 743,962</u>	<u>\$ 543,189</u>	<u>\$ 2,603,442</u>	<u>\$ 1,796,381</u>
Non-GAAP operating margin	48.3 %	42.6 %	44.4 %	41.0 %
GAAP net income	\$ 613,636	\$ 427,089	\$ 2,087,321	\$ 1,352,446
Stock-based compensation expense	81,358	64,954	296,756	230,934
Intangible asset amortization	6,690	9,316	33,437	33,650
Acquisition-related costs ⁽¹⁾	—	—	—	4,691
Gain on strategic investments	—	(3,358)	(18,699)	(27,479)
Tax benefit on stock-based awards	(40,561)	(37,177)	(174,122)	(113,502)
Income tax effect on non-GAAP exclusions	(12,795)	(15,677)	(41,283)	(32,482)
Legal settlement ⁽²⁾	16,000	—	16,000	—
Non-GAAP net income	<u>\$ 664,328</u>	<u>\$ 445,147</u>	<u>\$ 2,199,410</u>	<u>\$ 1,448,258</u>
GAAP diluted net income per share	\$ 1.92	\$ 1.35	\$ 6.58	\$ 4.27
Non-GAAP adjustments to net income	0.16	0.06	0.36	0.31
Non-GAAP diluted net income per share	<u>\$ 2.08</u>	<u>\$ 1.41</u>	<u>\$ 6.94</u>	<u>\$ 4.58</u>
Weighted-average shares used in computing diluted net income per share	318,845	315,201	317,135	316,459
Summary of Stock-Based Compensation Expense:				
Cost of revenue	\$ 3,273	\$ 3,075	\$ 12,789	\$ 9,688
Research and development	46,506	37,174	172,177	130,897
Sales and marketing	19,613	15,532	71,074	57,571
General and administrative	11,966	9,173	40,716	32,778
Total	<u>\$ 81,358</u>	<u>\$ 64,954</u>	<u>\$ 296,756</u>	<u>\$ 230,934</u>

(1) Represents costs associated with business combinations, which primarily include retention bonuses, and professional and consulting fees.

(2) In the quarter ended December 31, 2023, we agreed to pay \$16 million to settle an intellectual property dispute and we recorded this amount to general and administrative expenses.

ARISTA NETWORKS, INC.
Condensed Consolidated Balance Sheets
(Unaudited, in thousands)

	December 31, 2023	December 31, 2022
ASSETS		
CURRENT ASSETS:		
Cash and cash equivalents	\$ 1,938,606	\$ 671,707
Marketable securities	3,069,362	2,352,022
Accounts receivable	1,024,569	923,096
Inventories	1,945,180	1,289,706
Prepaid expenses and other current assets	412,518	314,217
Total current assets	8,390,235	5,550,748
Property and equipment, net	101,580	95,009
Acquisition-related intangible assets, net	88,768	122,205
Goodwill	268,531	265,924
Deferred tax assets	945,792	574,912
Other assets	151,900	166,612
TOTAL ASSETS	\$ 9,946,806	\$ 6,775,410
LIABILITIES AND STOCKHOLDERS' EQUITY		
CURRENT LIABILITIES:		
Accounts payable	\$ 435,059	\$ 232,572
Accrued liabilities	407,302	292,487
Deferred revenue	915,204	637,432
Other current liabilities	152,041	131,040
Total current liabilities	1,909,606	1,293,531
Income taxes payable	95,751	89,839
Deferred revenue, non-current	591,000	403,814
Other long-term liabilities	131,390	102,406
TOTAL LIABILITIES	2,727,747	1,889,590
STOCKHOLDERS' EQUITY:		
Common stock	31	31
Additional paid-in capital	2,108,331	1,780,714
Retained earnings	5,114,025	3,138,983
Accumulated other comprehensive income (loss)	(3,328)	(33,908)
TOTAL STOCKHOLDERS' EQUITY	7,219,059	4,885,820
TOTAL LIABILITIES AND STOCKHOLDERS' EQUITY	\$ 9,946,806	\$ 6,775,410

ARISTA NETWORKS, INC.
Condensed Consolidated Statements of Cash Flows
(Unaudited, in thousands)

	Twelve Months Ended December 31,	
	2023	2022
CASH FLOWS FROM OPERATING ACTIVITIES:		
Net income	\$ 2,087,321	\$ 1,352,446
Adjustments to reconcile net income to net cash provided by operating activities:		
Depreciation, amortization and other	70,630	62,700
Noncash lease expense	18,236	18,648
Stock-based compensation	296,756	230,934
Deferred income taxes	(370,796)	(244,382)
Gain on strategic investments	(18,699)	(27,479)
Amortization of investment premiums	(33,518)	12,767
Changes in operating assets and liabilities:		
Accounts receivable, net	(101,473)	(401,531)
Inventories	(655,474)	(638,948)
Other assets	(66,401)	(117,465)
Accounts payable	198,612	31,436
Other liabilities	123,694	70,704
Deferred revenue	464,958	98,957
Income taxes, net	20,168	44,026
Net cash provided by operating activities	2,034,014	492,813
CASH FLOWS FROM INVESTING ACTIVITIES:		
Proceeds from maturities of marketable securities	1,887,939	1,643,824
Proceeds from sale of marketable securities	67,284	193,782
Purchases of marketable securities	(2,606,878)	(1,418,857)
Purchases of property, equipment and intangible assets	(34,434)	(44,644)
Cash paid for business combination, net of cash acquired	1,799	(145,087)
Investment in notes and privately-held companies	(3,164)	(12,691)
Net cash provided by (used in) investing activities	(687,454)	216,327
CASH FLOWS FROM FINANCING ACTIVITIES:		
Proceeds from issuance of common stock under equity plans	62,093	48,411
Tax withholding paid on behalf of employees for net share settlement	(33,563)	(32,725)
Repurchase of common stock	(112,279)	(670,287)
Net cash used in financing activities	(83,749)	(654,601)
Effect of exchange rate changes	675	(3,611)
NET INCREASE/(DECREASE) IN CASH, CASH EQUIVALENTS AND RESTRICTED CASH	1,263,486	50,928
CASH, CASH EQUIVALENTS AND RESTRICTED CASH —Beginning of period	675,978	625,050
CASH, CASH EQUIVALENTS AND RESTRICTED CASH —End of period	\$ 1,939,464	\$ 675,978

Investor Contacts:

Arista Networks, Inc.
Liz Stine, 408-547-5885
Director, Investor Relations
liz@arista.com